



Module 12 Lecture - Social & Industrial-Organizational Psychology

Introductory Psychology

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Table of Contents

1	Overview and Introduction	2
1.1	Textbook Learning Objectives	2
1.2	Instructor Learning Objectives	2
1.3	Introduction	2
2	Overview of Social Psychology	3
2.1	Introduction	3
2.2	Situational and Dispositional Influences on Behavior	4
2.3	Fundamental Attribution Error	5
2.4	Actor-Observer Bias	7
2.5	Self-Serving Bias	8
2.6	Just-World Hypothesis	9
3	Self-presentation	10
3.1	Introduction	10
3.2	Social Roles	10
3.3	Social Norms	11
3.4	Scripts	11
4	Overview of Industrial-Organizational Psychology	12
4.1	Introduction and Subtypes	12
5	Organizational Psychology: The Social Dimension of Work	13
5.1	Introduction	13
5.2	Job Satisfaction	13
5.3	Work-Family Balance	14
5.4	Organizational Culture	15
6	Conclusion	15
6.1	Recap	15
	Key Terms	15
	Key Terms	17

1 Overview and Introduction

1.1 Textbook Learning Objectives

- Define social psychology
- Describe situational versus dispositional influences on behavior
- Describe the fundamental attribution error
- Explain actor-observer bias
- Describe self-serving bias
- Explain the just-world hypothesis
- Describe social roles and how they influence behavior
- Explain what social norms are and how they influence behavior
- Define script
- Define conformity and types of social influence
- Understand the scope of study in the field of industrial and organizational psychology
- Define organizational psychology
- Explain the significance of organizational culture

1.2 Instructor Learning Objectives

- Understand the respective scopes and interests of social and industrial-organizational psychology
- Be able to classify a study as being related to one of these domains
- Understand industrial-organizational psychology as an extension and connection to social psychology
- Appreciate the real-world importance of both sub-areas

1.3 Introduction

- **Social Psychology** is the modern sub-_____ of psychology focused upon social _____ behaviors and how our behaviors, thoughts, and feelings are socially driven
 - Example: Why do people take no action when they hear a cry for help, when they are in a group? Why do people act different when among different groups (friends vs strangers)?
- **Industrial-Organization (IO) Psychology** is a modern subfield of psychology focused mostly on how the _____ of examining human behavior applies to the _____ and our relationships within it
 - Example: Why do certain management styles improve or hurt performance? Why do people perform more effectively when working from

home than working from an office?

 Discuss: Using the examples above, see if you can make another 2 examples of studies that might fall under the broad umbrella of social psychology and IO psychology (make one example for each)

- These two areas have a lot of overlap, because we are often _____ in our workplace! A lot of prominent social psychologists end up creating _____ that are relevant to work, success, and productivity
 - We are going to take a look at some the core, well-established _____ in each of these areas - but there is much that we won't touch on! Read your book for additional ideas if you are interested

 Important

Both of these areas have vast amounts of misinformation and/or misunderstanding; be cautious in applying these concepts to real scenarios

2 Overview of Social Psychology

2.1 Introduction

- According to the _____, social psychologists:
“are interested in all aspects of personality and social interaction, exploring the influence of interpersonal and group relationships on human behavior.”
- Social psychologists broadly look at both _____ and _____ levels of _____ and behavior
 - **Intrapersonal** is focused upon _____ thoughts, feelings, and actions
 - Whereas, **Interpersonal** is the focus on group-level behaviors and trends
 - Across these areas, psychologists want to understand how our social _____ lends to how we think, feel, and act

* Yes, even the _____ still have social actions!

 Important

While there are studies done on animal socializing - most of 'social psychology' as a field is focused upon humans.

2.2 Situational and Dispositional Influences on Behavior

- As usual, us psychologists are interested in _____ something happens the way it does, e.g., why do we do that thing? why do we act in that way? why do we think that?
- Social psychologists, traditionally, had two _____ : situationism and dispositionism
 - The perspective of **situationism** holds that our actions are mostly a result of our _____, context, and environment
 - Alternatively, the perspective of **dispositionism** holds that our actions are mostly rooted in our _____ and temperament
 - At times, there has been _____ between these perspectives, but many psychologists now would agree that our actions are a result of both our _____ personality, and the situation we are in

 Discuss: Disagreement between theories that might both be partially true is fairly common in psychology. As review, what two theories of our auditory sense are both somewhat accurate in describing our ability to discriminate between different pitches? hint: they relate to hair cells in the cochlea

? Cheri lashes out at her friends due to a prank (at her expense) that ruined the organization of her workplace. What might Freud say about why Cheri does this?

- A) She is fixated in the anal stage
- B) She is fixated in the phallic stage
- C) She is surrounded by jerks, and feels like the only sane person
- D) She is not accepted among her colleagues, and thus they treat her worse, leading to resentment

Explanation:

2.3 Fundamental Attribution Error

- Especially in Western, **individualistic cultures**, like in the US, our society as a whole is _____ towards the _____ approach
 - However, this may _____ lead to an assumption that a misdeed or negative action is due to a personal _____ or personality failing
 - Our process of determining where we place “fault” is called **attribution**
 - E.g.:
 - * That person who is financially poor is so because they lack hard work
 - * My professor is just vindictive, and that’s why they give low grades
 - * That person who cut me off on the road is reckless, careless, and a selfish person
 - * That thief stole the baby formula because they are greedy and want to sell it

? Consider this scenario: someone wants to find a job and employment, but keeps getting in trouble for stealing food - which personality theorist might say this person is unable to find security because their basic need for food is not yet met?

- A) Abraham Maslow
- B) Sigmund Freud
- C) Jean Piaget
- D) Alfred Adler

Explanation:

- All of these prior examples attribute actions to a person's _____

 Important

To be clear: it is quite possible these things are true, BUT, this assumption is not always correct

- However, this _____ tendency to “assume the worst” about people can be _____ to attribute the failing to the disposition of the person, rather than the circumstances
 - This is called the **fundamental attribution error**
 - From examples before:
 - * That person who is financially poor may have had a major medical accident and been unjustly fired from their job
 - * My professor teaches a naturally hard class, and has to grade at a high level to make sure we are well-prepared, even if that results in a lower grade
 - * There are both situational _____

 Discuss: Consider the other two examples from before, how could you 'turn around' those stories to represent a circumstance leading to this result

- On the flip side, it seems that **collectivist culture**, or that which emphasizes the _____ and broader community appear to be more biased toward a _____ perspective
 - Cross-cultural studies appear to suggest that people in _____ cultures are less prone to the fundamental attribution error

 Discuss: Consider this scenario: You see a man pull into a parking lot at a high speed, and quickly pull into handicap spot, when he is lacking a placard for it. Write both a dispositional and situational assessment of this man's behavior

- Sometimes the fundamental attribution error can manifest as _____ remembering certain parts of a person's actions

 Which type of memory is most related to our memories of events as they occur?

- A) Episodic memory
- B) Procedural memory
- C) Anecdotal memory
- D) Short-term memory

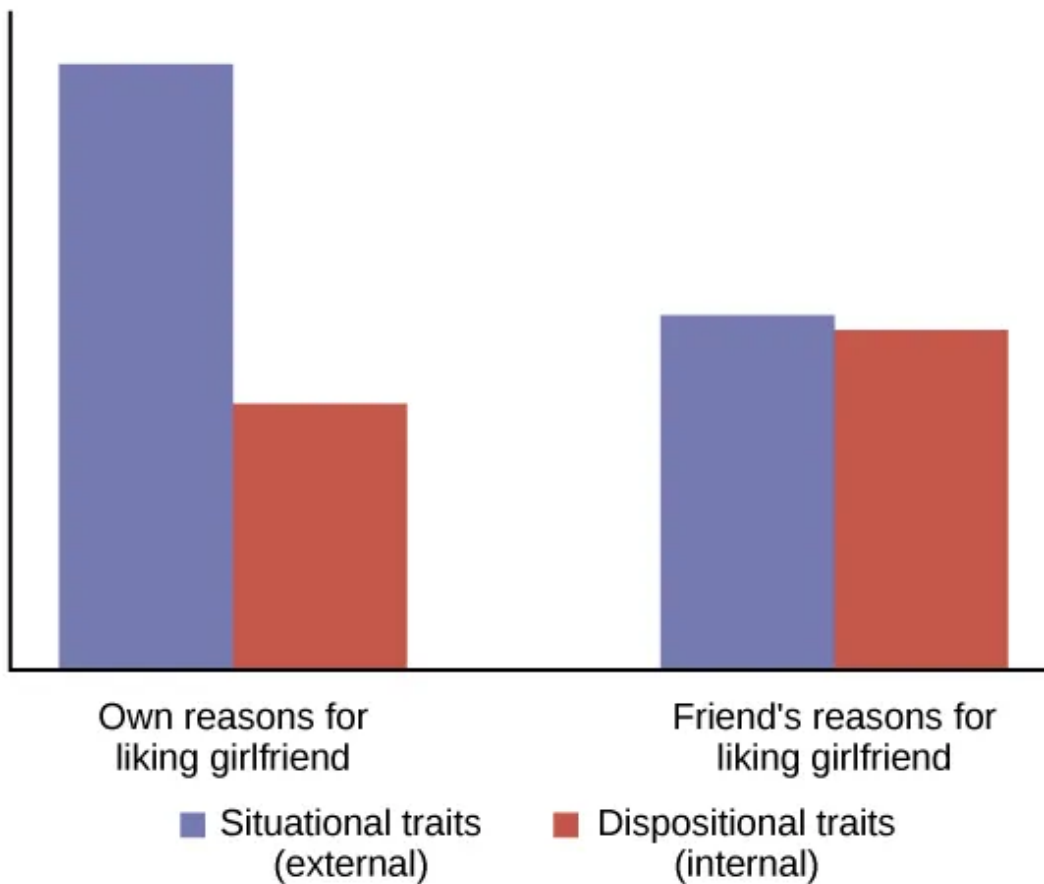
Explanation:

2.4 Actor-Observer Bias

 Important

We are often generous to ourselves, but less so to others - be mindful of how readily you jump to assumptions, and also mindful of how often you 'make excuses' based on your circumstances

- The **actor-observer bias** is our _____ to assume that others actions are primarily a result of their _____, while our actions are mostly situational



? I catch a student cheating on a piece of homework - which personality theorist would say they say it's because they feel inferior to their peers and just wanted to turn in work as good as the other students?

- A) Abraham Maslow
- B) Sigmund Freud
- C) Jean Piaget
- D) Alfred Adler

Explanation:

2.5 Self-Serving Bias

- The [self-serving bias](#) can almost be thought of as an _____

to the actor-observer bias

- This is where we prefer to attribute our _____ to our internal traits, but our failures to situational circumstances
- This also extends to those that we _____, such as close friends and family

 Important

Sometimes our defense of our friends can be pretty misguided.

 Discuss: Consider the scenario in which your favorite sports team wins or loses. What sorts of things are you likely to say about *why* they won or loss?

 Which theory of motivation suggests we are motivated to behaviors, in part, for a sense of achievement?

- A) Drive theory
- B) Instinctual theory
- C) Hierarchy of needs
- D) Social motivation

Explanation:

2.6 Just-World Hypothesis

- The **Just-World Hypothesis** is the somewhat _____ belief that good things happen to good people, and bad things happen to bad people.
- Unfortunately, one negative _____ of this belief, is that we tend to shift our opinion of people based upon their circumstances they suffer from, often described as victim-blaming

- This bad thing happened to you → you must have deserved it somehow
- E.g., negative opinions of those who have been diagnosed with AIDS, suffered domestic abuse, suffered homelessness
- Example: Instructor's partner

 Discuss: Do you think the world is just, as this hypothesis states?

3 Self-presentation

3.1 Introduction

Important

Even if you don't realize it, our environment almost always plays a role in what we do and how we act

- The previous section, we focused much on how we _____ and understand the world around us, but we also change how we _____ to the world

3.2 Social Roles

- Each of us have a set of different **social roles**
 - E.g., I am an instructor, a psychometrist, a partner, a brother, a son, etc.
 - For each of these _____, there is an _____ set of behaviors, mannerisms, language, etc.
 - It is normal for us to _____ our behaviors based upon what role we are currently “in”

 Discuss: Think about the sort of roles you fulfill, and list them out, like I just did

3.3 Social Norms

- A **social norm** is a set of _____ that a group or community has for its members
 - _____ against the norms can cause a person to be removed or ostracized from a group
 - One of the most stressful experiences can be not being aware of the norms to follow - common in culture shock!

 Discuss: Think about when you are sitting in a lecture class, what sort of unspoken expectations are there about how you ought to behave?

3.4 Scripts

- **Scripts** are our _____ how we “ought to” act and behave in a certain scenario
 - Example: when you go to order food at a fast food counter, you’ll greet the cashier, state what things you want to order, hand over your payment, get a receipt, and then wait nearby for your food
- Scripts can be very culture-dependent, and one might be _____ when a script “doesn’t work”!

 Discuss: Think about a time that you didn't have a script for a scenario and felt like a 'fish out of water'

4 Overview of Industrial-Organizational Psychology

4.1 Introduction and Subtypes

- Industrial-organization, or IO, psychology, is all about how humans think, act, and behave at _____!
 - I like to think of it as a part of _____ psychology, because it often involves understanding how people act as part of _____, and how that contributes to work
 - There are 3 divisions within this: industrial psychology, organizational psychology, and human factors psychology
- **Industrial psychology** is all focused on understanding “fit” to jobs and how one is evaluate and _____ within that job
 - Example: A study on how certain personality types or levels of extraversion predict better performance in a high-stakes sales roles
- **Organizational psychology** focuses on different group _____, cultures, toxicity, and management in the workplace
 - Example: A study on how more permissive or authoritative workplace management changes conversations and frequency of messaging
- **Human factors psychology** is then focused on how employees interact with their workspace and tools
 - Example: A study on how workplace ergonomics affects worker productivity and focus

? A researcher is looking at how a new desk design and mousepad reduce repetitive stress injuries among programmers

- A) Industrial psychology
- B) Organizational psychology
- C) Human factors psychology
- D) None of the above

Explanation:

5 Organizational Psychology: The Social Dimension of Work

5.1 Introduction

- This subarea of IO psychology is the most closely related to _____ psychology, so it ties into what we talk through in those sections
- We will walk through several of the social _____ of the workplace and occupations

5.2 Job Satisfaction

- **Job satisfaction** is how _____ we feel about the nature of work, and our job
 - It can be a complex relationship between our _____, the people we work with, and the nature of our work that determines if we feel _____ or not
 - Satisfaction is both _____ and _____, as it might manifest both as a sense of feeling fulfilled intellectually while not being overwhelmed

 Discuss: If you are working a job, or have worked one, think of one thing that has made you feel more satisfied with your job, and something that has made you feel less satisfied.

Factors Involved in Job Satisfaction and Dissatisfaction

Factor	Description
Autonomy	Individual responsibility, control over decisions
Work content	Variety, challenge, role clarity
Communication	Feedback
Financial rewards	Salary and benefits
Growth and development	Personal growth, training, education
Promotion	Career advancement opportunity
Coworkers	Professional relations or adequacy
Supervision and feedback	Support, recognition, fairness
Workload	Time pressure, tedium
Work demands	Extra work requirements, insecurity of position

5.3 Work-Family Balance

- Work-family balance is the way that work _____ and harms the time we are able to spend at time home versus the time at work.
- Because work takes up so much of our lives, there are _____ ways that conflict might arise
 - Time devoted to work makes it difficult to fulfill requirements of family, or vice versa,
 - Strain from participation in work makes it difficult to fulfill requirements of family, or vice versa, and
 - Specific behaviors required by work make it difficult to fulfill the requirements of family, or vice versa.

5.4 Organizational Culture

 Discuss: If you are working a job, or have worked one, how would you intuitively describe the 'culture' of your workplace?

- **Organizational culture** is a pretty broad term to describe:
 - _____
 - _____
 - Interactions among _____
- Some departments or individual _____ within the organization, may have distinct or individual cultures that are different than the larger organization

6 Conclusion

6.1 Recap

- Humans are social creatures, and much of our lives are spent in the presence of other people, and thus, much of our time is spent adapting our behaviors, emotions, and thoughts to our social context
- We have a complicated way of dealing with the myriad of social situations we find ourselves in, and we also make a lot of judgements on other individuals and their actions. But we can run into many biases and problems in these judgements
- Work is a large, important part of our life and IO psychology gives us some insight and language to describe the science of working and what makes it good and bad

Key Terms

A

actor-observer bias Our tendency to more readily attribute other people's actions to their disposition, while attributing our own actions to our circumstances [7](#)

attribution Our process by which we judge whether other people or ourselves have acted in a way due to our disposition and/or situation [5](#)

C

collectivist culture Culture that emphasize the good of the group and situational perspective [6](#)

D

dispositionism The perspective that our social thoughts, actions, and feelings are primarily a result of our personality and temperament [4](#)

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fundamental attribution error The tendency to assume that a person's poor behavior is due to a moral or personality failing, rather than their circumstances [6](#)

H

Human factors psychology Subarea of IO psychology is about how employees interact with their tools, computers, and physical workspace [12](#)

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individualistic cultures Culture that put emphasis on autonomy and individual achievement [5](#)

Industrial psychology Subarea of IO psychology is about assessing effectiveness and evaluation in jobs [12](#)

Industrial-Organization (IO) Psychology The modern subarea of psychology focused upon behaviors, cognition, and feelings in the workplace and occupations, related to productivity, cooperation, and problems [2](#)

Interpersonal The focus on group-level behaviors and trends [3](#)

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Job satisfaction The extent to which someone enjoys the job they do, and whether they feel content and tolerating of what is expected of them [13](#)

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Work-family balance The way that work interacts with our family time and life [14](#)

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